

Chapter 25 - Banquet

The next evening, the Feng family's driver delivered the family of three punctually to the entrance of Maoting Hotel¹.

Although General Manager Wang had wanted a second child to be a son, now that he really had a daughter, he hadn't mistreated her too badly. Tonight's full moon celebration clearly showed he had put thought into it.

Feng Yue obediently followed beside Mother Feng, saying quietly: "General Manager Wang seems to value this daughter quite a bit. It looks like many people will come tonight."

Mother Feng chuckled sarcastically and whispered to Feng Yue with her hand covering her lips: "Look at what kind of people are coming. Every one of them is in suits and ties, some even have assistants following them. How much of their congratulations could be sincere?"

Hearing this, Feng Yue looked around. Indeed, as her mother said, a large portion of the people coming were probably business partners who had commercial dealings with General Manager Wang. Every one of them was formally dressed, and as soon as they entered the venue, they began chatting about business in small groups.

Feng Yue raised her eyebrows noncommittally. It seemed she was still too young.

The family of three walked into the venue. Before long, Father Feng saw General Manager Wang, so he told Mother Feng and went forward to make small talk.

As for Mother Feng, she took Feng Yue to the rest room on the second floor of the venue to see Mrs. Wang and her full-moon daughter.

General Manager Wang had been chatting idly with several other CEOs around him, but when he saw Father Feng walking over, he quickly went up to greet him.

The two families were neighbors, and they didn't interact frequently, but the unusual in-law relationship between the Feng and Yan families forced General Manager Wang to take the Feng family seriously.

However, even without that relationship between the Feng and Yan families, just Feng Hehai² alone—this cunning old fox—was enough to make General Manager Wang not dare to underestimate them.

"General Manager Feng! Long time no see."

"General Manager Wang has been quite busy lately. Today we must congratulate you on welcoming your precious daughter."

"Hahaha, thank you, thank you!" General Manager Wang laughed heartily, seeming genuinely fond of his little daughter.

Feng Yue followed behind Mother Feng, caught a glimpse of this scene, and asked curiously:

"Mom, do you think General Manager Wang likes his little daughter or not?"

"This person is hypocritical to death. Even if he didn't like her from the bottom of his heart, he wouldn't show it. However, if he really loved this little daughter, he wouldn't have made today's full moon celebration look like a business reception."

Feng Yue pursed her lips. She really admired these people who mixed in the business world. She always felt their stage shouldn't be the marketplace, but under the spotlight. With such acting skills, they might as well become actors.

Seeing Feng Yue's expression, Mother Feng immediately knew what she was thinking, so she smiled and said: "Alright, after we see Mrs. Wang, we'll go downstairs and find a corner to wait for dinner. But it would be good if you could make some friends here. I see that for the sake of appearances today, everyone should have brought their children out as cover."

"Cover?"

"Yes, to prevent this full moon celebration from really becoming a business reception."

"So I'm also cover that you and Dad brought out?" Feng Yue smiled mischievously.

"You little rascal." Mother Feng laughingly patted her head. "Do your dad and I need you as cover? We could have not come today and it would have been fine."

Feng Yue giggled twice, then linked arms with Mother Feng affectionately.

The mother and daughter came to the rest room door, knocked, and saw Mrs. Wang wearing a dark red evening gown. Naturally, she also saw them.

"Mrs. Wang, congratulations." Mother Feng greeted her with a smile all over her face.

Mrs. Wang curved her triangular eyes³ and smiled at the corners of her mouth. "Oh my, Mrs. Feng, thank you, thank you."

Then Mrs. Wang looked at Feng Yue beside Mother Feng. "This is your Feng Yue, right? She came with you today too."

"Hello, Auntie. Congratulations, Auntie."

"So well-behaved, so well-behaved." Mrs. Wang wasn't particularly vindictive, but she still held a grudge about Mother Feng having snatched away the nutritionist she had her eye on some time ago. "I heard before that you haven't been feeling well recently. Are you better now?"

Mother Feng's expression stiffened. She knew this woman still remembered the nutritionist incident. She smiled and took over the conversation: "Just so-so, but now that we have a nutritionist at home, it's much better than before."

Feng Yue smiled and nodded, then walked to the baby crib in the rest room to look at the little baby.

The baby had probably just finished nursing and fallen asleep. Her little face was rosy from sleep, and her whole body emanated the scent of milk.

Looking at such a small child being used by her father to maintain business relationships made her feel somewhat melancholy. She wondered if there was anyone in this world who truly looked forward to her arrival with love.

Mother Feng and Feng Yue chatted with Mrs. Wang upstairs for a while, and the banquet downstairs was about to begin. Mrs. Wang had to carry the child downstairs, so the mother and daughter left first.

After leaving the rest room, the mother and daughter noticed the particularly noisy atmosphere in the venue downstairs.

Logically speaking, this banquet was still ostensibly a child's full moon celebration. Even if those people who came treating it as a business reception wanted to discuss business, they wouldn't be so blatant and noisy about it.

The mother and daughter looked at each other in confusion. Only after they went downstairs did they understand what had happened.

And standing at the foot of the stairs, Feng Yue made eye contact with someone who shouldn't have appeared here.

Yan Lin was surrounded by three people. Besides Special Assistant Mo Yixu, the other two were also capable assistants from her secretarial office.

At this moment, these three were playing Tai Chi⁴ with the group of people who wanted to chat with Yan Lin. Yan Lin herself was talking with General Manager Wang and Father Feng about something.

When Mother Feng saw Yan Lin's figure, she basically understood what was happening.

The appearance of the Yan family at this small full moon celebration probably surprised General Manager Wang, who was hosting tonight's banquet, the most.

The number of invitations and invitation letters delivered to the Yan family each year was countless. Except for banquets the Yan family regularly attended, they had almost no presence at other banquets.

But today, at this small full moon celebration, Yan Lin had attended. This was an unexpected bonus for those who had come treating it as a business reception.

However, Yan Lin probably also knew what kind of situation would occur if she came to attend the banquet, so she had brought more than just Mo Yixu as a special assistant.

Mother Feng looked at her old man's obviously somewhat awkward expression, then turned to look at Feng Yue's expression beside her, and sighed inwardly.

Feng Yue stood at the foot of the stairs, looked at Yan Lin with an indifferent expression, then shifted her gaze away.

Yan Lin saw all her movements, but when she watched the other party shift her gaze away with complete disinterest in her, she still couldn't help but feel her heart tighten, and even her complexion became much worse.

General Manager Wang and Father Feng naturally also noticed her abnormality. The two followed Yan Lin's gaze and only then saw the mother and daughter standing at the foot of the stairs.

Although Yan Lin and Feng Yue's marriage hadn't been widely announced, everyone who should know knew. Naturally, these two people's divorce was almost no secret in their circle either.

General Manager Wang had been able to navigate the business world for decades and still had some perception. For things he shouldn't hear or see, he could become blind and deaf on the spot, so he found an excuse to leave first.

Because Father Feng was still standing beside Yan Lin, Mother Feng couldn't just abandon her old man either.

However, Feng Yue didn't have these concerns. Her dad had her mom to accompany him, so she wouldn't go over to Yan Lin's side to join the excitement.

Feng Yue whispered a few words in Mother Feng's ear, then took a glass of fruit juice from a server's tray and found a corner to stay in.

Yan Lin's gaze never moved away from her, but seeing Mother Feng walking over here, Yan Lin couldn't ignore her either.

"A... Good evening, Auntie." Yan Lin almost blurted out "Mom," but caught herself. She had never known before that changing how she addressed someone was such a difficult thing to get used to.

"A-Lin came too. We haven't seen you for a while, and you look like you've lost quite a bit of weight." Mother Feng chatted with Yan Lin with a normal expression.

Yan Lin curved her lips in a smile. "The company has been quite busy recently."

"No matter how busy you are, you must eat well."

"Mm, thank you for your concern, Auntie."

Mother Feng and Father Feng chatted with her casually for a few more sentences, then General Manager Wang's voice came from the banquet hall.

After all, it was still a child's full moon celebration, so as the father, General Manager Wang naturally had to go on stage to say a few words. During this time, almost no one in the banquet hall would move around anymore—this was basic respect for the host.

As tonight's most eye-catching presence, even more so than the host, Yan Lin naturally couldn't move around casually and attract attention. So her desire to find Feng Yue to talk was thus killed in the cradle.

Yan Lin stood in place, but her gaze fell on Feng Yue, who was standing alone in the distance.

She had come to attend this full moon celebration that had nothing to do with her tonight for only one purpose: Feng Yue.

Yan Lin originally didn't know that this family was Feng Yue's neighbors. It was Mo Yixu who reminded her after seeing the invitation.

She didn't know whether Feng Yue would come to attend this full moon celebration. She came tonight to try her luck, so when she only saw Father Feng after entering the venue, she was somewhat disappointed.

But when she saw Feng Yue's figure appear at the foot of the stairs, her heart that had previously sunk rose again. She didn't know why, but when facing Feng Yue, she always had an emotion in her heart that she couldn't face but also longed for the other party.

General Manager Wang's speech didn't last too long, because he clearly understood how many of the people he had invited truly blessed his child from their hearts.

With Yan Lin's status laid out there, and the news of her divorce from Feng Yue also laid out there, those who had brought their children tonight as cover began to feel restless.

Mo Yixu and the others could still help fend off those company CEOs who came to discuss cooperation, but these rich young people with ulterior motives toward Yan Lin were not something they could handle.

However, fortunately, Yan Lin's own aura of keeping strangers at bay was still quite strong. Not many people dared to come up and talk to her. In the end, she easily escaped from around these people.

Yan Lin walked toward Feng Yue somewhat awkwardly, holding a glass of champagne. Beside Feng Yue stood a girl about her age, and it looked like the two were chatting quite happily.

No one in this banquet hall didn't recognize Yan Lin, so when that girl saw Yan Lin walking this way, she tactfully left.

Yan Lin stopped in front of Feng Yue. As soon as she stood there, Feng Yue expressionlessly prepared to leave.

"A-Yue... I want to talk with you."

Feng Yue, with her back to her, stopped and said calmly: "President Yan, there are many people who want to chat with you tonight. I don't have time."

After saying this, she walked directly into the crowd in the banquet hall.

Footnotes:

¹ "Maoting Hotel" (茂庭酒店) - A fictional upscale hotel name.

² "Feng Hehai" (封鹤海) - Feng Yue's father's full name, showing his reputation as a shrewd businessman.

³ "Triangular eyes" (三角眼) - A description suggesting Mrs. Wang has sharp, somewhat cunning-looking eyes.

⁴ "Playing Tai Chi" (打太极) - A metaphorical expression meaning to deflect or evade direct questions/requests, like the flowing movements of Tai Chi martial arts.